

Reconnaissance Report

Task: Ethical Hacking Task 01 – Passive Reconnaissance

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Name: Sayali Kute

1. Target Information

Field	Details
Target Website	Government Polytechnic Nashik
Domain Name	gpnashik.ac.in
Website URL	https://gpnashik.ac.in
Reconnaissance Type	Passive Reconnaissance
Purpose	To gather publicly available information about the target website without interacting with or exploiting the target system.

2. WHOIS Results

A WHOIS lookup was performed to gather publicly available domain registration information.

Parameter	Value
Domain Name	gpnashik.ac.in
Registrar	ERNET India
Registration Date	14 February 2017
Expiry Date	14 February 2029
Domain Status	OK
Name Servers	christian.ns.cloudflare.com irma.ns.cloudflare.com

Observation

The domain is registered with **ERNET India** and uses **Cloudflare** name servers. The domain registration is active and valid until **14 February 2029**.

3. DNS Information

DNS enumeration was performed to identify the domain's DNS records.

A Records

Domain	IP Address
gpnashik.ac.in	104.21.6.107
gpnashik.ac.in	172.67.134.187

MX Records

- aspmx.l.google.com
- alt1.aspmx.l.google.com
- alt2.aspmx.l.google.com
- alt3.aspmx.l.google.com
- alt4.aspmx.l.google.com

NS Records

- christian.ns.cloudflare.com
- irma.ns.cloudflare.com

TXT Record

No publicly available TXT record was found.

Observation

The website uses **Cloudflare** for DNS hosting and protection, while **Google Workspace** is used for email services.

4. Technologies Identified

Website technology analysis identified the following technologies.

Technology	Result
CMS	No CMS detected
Programming Language	PHP 8.3.30

Technology	Result
CDN	Cloudflare
JavaScript CDN	jsDelivr
JavaScript CDN	cdnjs
Hosted Libraries	Google Hosted Libraries

Observation

The website appears to be a custom-developed PHP application rather than one using a popular Content Management System. Cloudflare provides DNS management, website security, and content delivery.

5. Security Headers

The website was analyzed using SecurityHeaders.com.

Header	Status
Content-Security-Policy	Present
Strict-Transport-Security	Missing
X-Frame-Options	Missing
X-Content-Type-Options	Missing
Referrer-Policy	Missing
Permissions-Policy	Missing

Security Grade

Grade: D

Observation

The website has implemented **Content-Security-Policy (CSP)**, which provides protection against Cross-Site Scripting (XSS). However, several recommended HTTP security headers are missing, resulting in an overall security grade of **D**. Implementing the missing headers would improve browser-side security and reduce exposure to common web attacks.

6. Robots.txt Findings

The website contains a **robots.txt** file.

Findings

- The robots.txt file provides instructions to search engine crawlers.
- It helps control which parts of the website can or cannot be indexed.
- No publicly accessible sitemap.xml file was found.

Observation

The robots.txt file assists search engines in understanding crawler permissions, while the absence of a sitemap means search engines rely primarily on internal website links for page discovery.

7. Overall Observations

- The domain registration information is publicly available through WHOIS.
 - Cloudflare is used for DNS hosting and website protection.
 - Google Workspace is configured for handling email services.
 - The website is developed using PHP and does not use a detectable CMS.
 - Only the Content-Security-Policy security header is implemented, while several important HTTP security headers are missing.
 - The website contains a robots.txt file but no publicly accessible sitemap.
 - All information collected during this task was obtained through passive reconnaissance using publicly available sources without attempting any unauthorized access.
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8. Conclusion

This reconnaissance exercise helped me understand the importance of passive information gathering during the initial phase of ethical hacking. I learned how to collect publicly available information about a target website using tools such as WHOIS lookup, DNS enumeration services, technology identification tools, and HTTP security header analyzers. These tools provided valuable insights into the website's domain registration, DNS configuration, email services, underlying technologies, and browser security settings without directly interacting with the target system.

I also learned that publicly available information can reveal useful details about a website's infrastructure while remaining completely legal and ethical when used responsibly. The analysis showed that the target website uses Cloudflare for DNS and security services, Google Workspace for email, and PHP for application development. It also highlighted areas where security could be improved, particularly by implementing additional HTTP security headers. Overall, this task strengthened my understanding of the reconnaissance

phase, demonstrated the value of passive information gathering, and emphasized the importance of following ethical guidelines throughout the assessment process.